

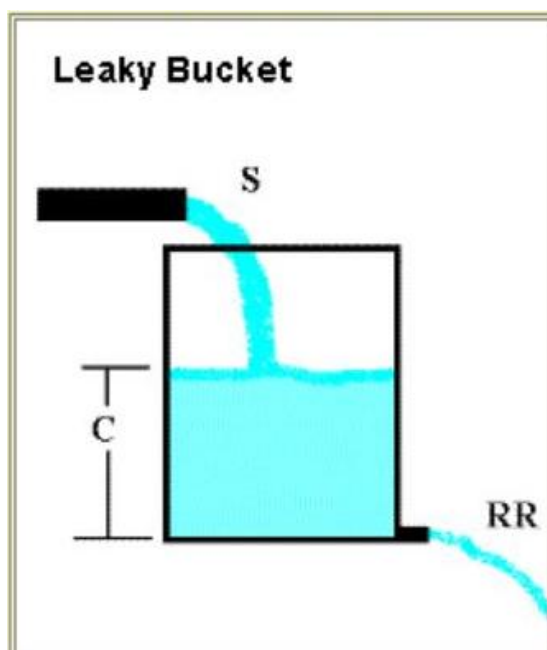
CO₂ Box Model

We are going to make a box model to try and explain CO₂ concentrations.

I am freely taking from this website http://serc.carleton.edu/quantskills/activities/co2_global.html and this website. http://serc.carleton.edu/quantskills/activities/co2_global.html Robert Mackay is the person behind this. <http://www.atmosedu.com/>

I have double checked the equations against the website already. But please make sure I have no typos.

We are going to treat the atmosphere as a simple box model. Here is a figure describing it. It is simple. Think about that we are adding CO₂, it is building up in the atmosphere, and then it is leaving. The rate we are adding is increasing but it is leaving at a constant rate.



this makes the equation

$$\frac{dC}{dt} = S - \frac{C}{\tau}$$

C is the Concentration of CO₂ in the atmosphere in ppm.

S is the amount of CO₂ we are adding every year in ppm.

tau (τ) is the residence time of CO₂ in years.

So basically we are saying the changing the CO₂ over time is equal to the amount we put in and how quickly it leaves.

Now we just need to solve it!

The answers are from here. <http://www.atmosedu.com/physlets/GlobalPollution/instructorNotes.htm>

$$C = C_o e^{-t/\tau} + e^{-t/\tau} \int_0^t S t' e^{-t'/\tau} dt'$$

I am not sure about the t-prime and I am looking into it. I think t is total time and t prime is at any time step. But we know the source term is changing and increasing over time. But this is the solution over time telling us the concentration C at any time in the atmosphere.

But we also need to know how much CO2 we are adding

$$S(t) = S_o e^{Rt}$$

$$S_o$$

is the initial addition to the atmosphere at time zero

R

is the rate of growth of emission

Before we solve the whole equation lets just solve for S(t).

So read in your mauna luo data

We will need datetime today

Final equation

As you will see below. The final solution we will solve is

$$C = C_o e^{-t/\tau} + \frac{S_o}{R + \frac{1}{\tau}} [e^{Rt} - e^{-t/\tau}]$$

τ

tau is the lifetime of CO₂ in the atmosphere in years. We use 120.

```
In [2]: %matplotlib ipynb
import pandas as pd
import numpy as np
import matplotlib.pyplot as plt
from scipy import stats
from matplotlib.backends.backend_pdf import PdfPages

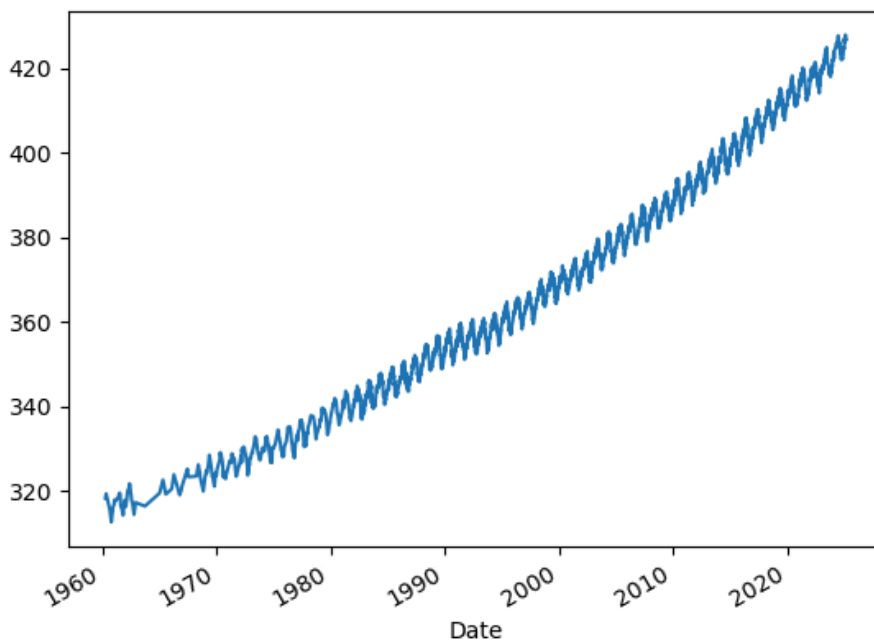
import datetime
```

```
In [6]: url='https://scrippsco2.ucsd.edu/assets/data/atmospheric/stations/flask_co2/daily/daily_flask_co2'
df_mlo=pd.read_csv(url,skiprows=76,usecols=[0,5,6],names=['Date','Flag','CO2'],
                  ,parse_dates=['Date'],
                  ,index_col='Date',header=None)
df_mlo=df_mlo[df_mlo['Flag']==0].copy()
```

```
fig,ax=plt.subplots()
df_mlo['C02'].plot(ax=ax)
```

Out[6]: <Axes: xlabel='Date'>

Figure



to make this work you will need elapsed time. This is a little tricky to make and takes a few tricks. lets run through them.

First you need a start time which is the first index. But since it is an index you need to use index to get the values out. to get the values out of an index you type this

```
In [7]: df_mlo.index
```

```
Out[7]: DatetimeIndex(['1960-03-30', '1960-03-31', '1960-04-24', '1960-08-18',
                        '1960-10-06', '1960-12-01', '1961-01-04', '1961-01-17',
                        '1961-03-01', '1961-06-01',
                        ...,
                        '2024-12-06', '2024-12-17', '2024-12-24', '2024-12-31',
                        '2025-01-07', '2025-01-14', '2025-01-21', '2025-01-29',
                        '2025-01-31', '2025-02-11'],
                        dtype='datetime64[ns]', name='Date', length=2383, freq=None)
```

to get the 0 row which is the start time you use your brackets

```
In [15]: df_mlo.index[0]
```

```
Out[15]: Timestamp('1960-03-30 00:00:00')
```

to get the elapsed you subtract the index from the start time. This works but gives funny results so THIS WON'T WORK YET!

```
In [18]: df_mlo['elapsed'] = (df_mlo.index - df_mlo.index[0])
```

```
In [19]: df_mlo.head()
```

Out[19]:

	Flag	CO2	elapsed
			Date
1960-03-30	0	318.27	0 days
1960-03-31	0	318.29	1 days
1960-04-24	0	319.33	25 days
1960-08-18	0	315.56	141 days
1960-10-06	0	312.62	190 days

In [20]: `df_mlo.elapsed.dtype`

Out[20]: `dtype('<m8[ns]')`

So we have no idea what that elapsed time type means and we can't do math on it. So we google stackoverflow and ask for help. This is not the best post but it helps. <http://stackoverflow.com/questions/24588437/convert-date-to-float-for-linear-regression-on-pandas-data-frame> If you divide a datetime by a timedelta it converts it for you. It is wonky. And if we divide by 365 days it will put it into years.

In [21]: `df_mlo['elapsed'] = (df_mlo.index - df_mlo.index[0])\
/datetime.timedelta(days=365)`

In [22]: `df_mlo.head()`

Out[22]:

	Flag	CO2	elapsed
			Date
1960-03-30	0	318.27	0.000000
1960-03-31	0	318.29	0.002740
1960-04-24	0	319.33	0.068493
1960-08-18	0	315.56	0.386301
1960-10-06	0	312.62	0.520548

so we have an elapsed time. so now lets compute an S at every time step.

Set your S_0 to 3 ppm. Set R to 1% which is 1/100 which is .01

then plot the S over time.

Flashback

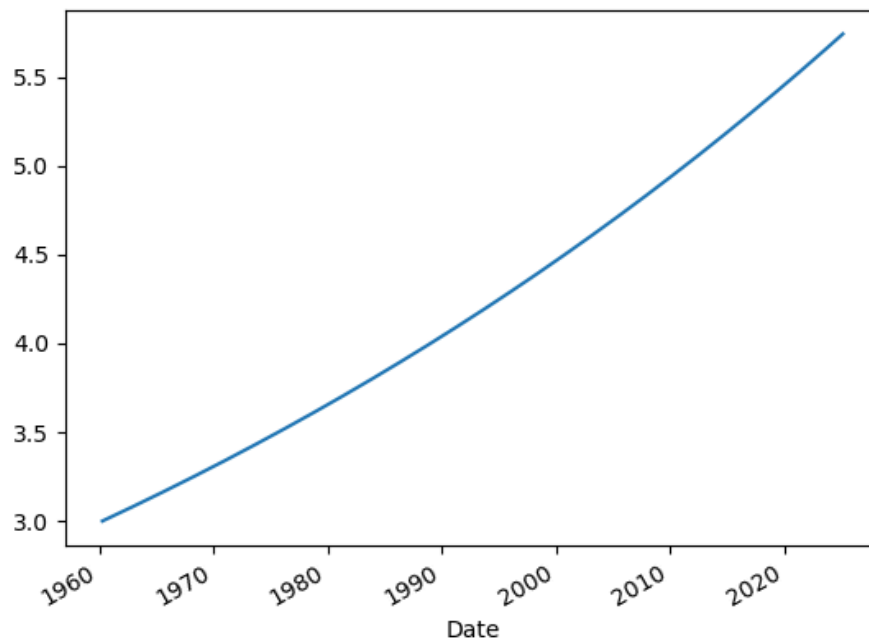
Make sure to put in decimal places also exponent e is np.exp

In [23]: `So=3.
R=.01
df_mlo['S']=So*np.exp(R*df_mlo.elapsed)

fig,ax=plt.subplots()
df_mlo.S.plot(ax=ax)`

Out[23]: `<Axes: xlabel='Date'>`

Figure



Now here is the solution for the whole CO2 equation.

<http://www.atmosedu.com/physlets/GlobalPollution/solution.jpg>

$$C = C_o e^{-t/\tau} + \frac{S_o}{R + \frac{1}{\tau}} [e^{Rt} - e^{-t/\tau}]$$

Solve the equation and figure out the best fit parameters for CO2. How much has CO2 output been growing over the years?

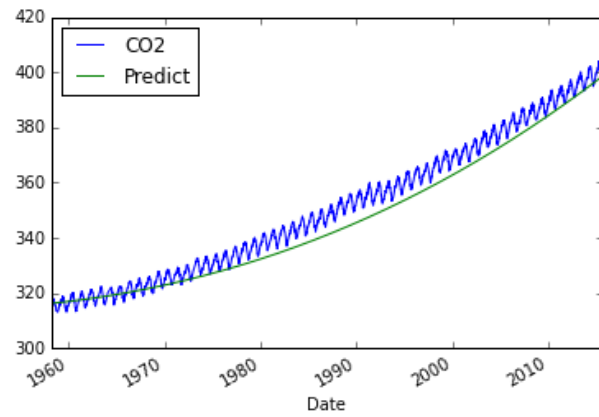
set tau to 120.0. Remember this is a simple box model so real life might be slightly different.

What would CO₂ look like now if the growth rate R was halved starting at the beginning of the dataset?

here are my answers. Good luck

In [36]:

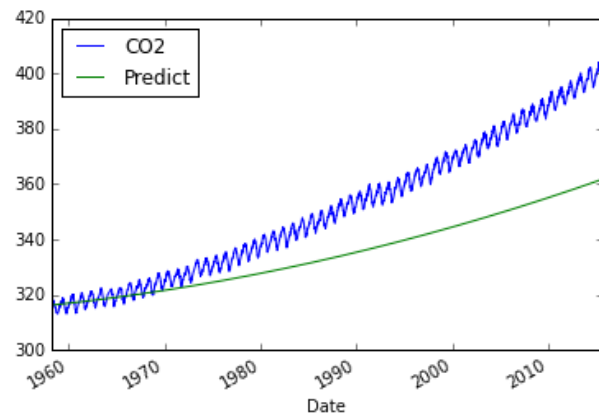
Out[36]: <matplotlib.axes._subplots.AxesSubplot at 0x1fb12748>



My answer with the R halved.

In [37]:

Out[37]: <matplotlib.axes._subplots.AxesSubplot at 0x1fd2e240>



In []: